

Moto watch 2026

Staying functional in daily life and that may be enough

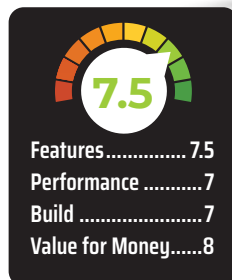
Remember the Moto 360 smartwatch? Not the third-gen model that came to India in 2021, almost 1.5 years after the global launch. But the OG Android smartwatch from 2014 and 2015. Back then, the Apple Watch didn't even launch until 2015, and the Moto 360 was established as a premium smartwatch option. However, over the years, Motorola has moved away from the smartwatch market, and to date, the brand hasn't shown any keen interest. Of course, as I mentioned, out of the blue, the company did launch the 3rd-gen Moto 360 in 2019, but the main reason behind this whole context is Motorola getting back into the mix with the Moto Watch 2026.

Will this be a serious return to form, or just another attempt to fill a product lineup? Sure, the Moto Watch arrives with confident claims. You get an AMOLED display, Polar-powered fitness insights, dual-frequency GPS, Bluetooth calling, AI notification summaries and battery life that promises to stretch well beyond a week. This sounds like a well-planned comeback, at least on paper. But as always, spec sheets only tell part of the story.

I used the Moto Watch 2026 thoroughly. This review is more of a long-term ownership rather than chasing an embargo deadline. I have literally used this watch, day in and day out, through crowded metro rides, long office hours, evening walks, sleep tracking and frequent Bluetooth calls to understand how it behaves as a daily driver.

DESIGN

Motorola may not have made smartwatches in a long while, but that doesn't mean the company has forgotten how



by Gorilla Glass 3. Just like the Moto 360 watches from the past, the new Moto Watch 2026 looks premium at first glance, especially in the silver colour.

What stands out immediately is how light it feels. At just 35 grams without the strap, the Moto Watch 2026 is one of those watches you stop noticing after a few hours. For someone who tracks sleep regularly, that comfort matters. It never felt intrusive at night, and even after a full day of notifications and occasional workouts, there was no fatigue. Comfort is one of its strongest qualities.

Not everything about the watch can be perfect. I'd like to point out that the rotating crown on the Moto Watch 2026 is overly sensitive. I mean, it works, but slight accidental touches can rotate it

and shift screens unintentionally. Not a major flaw, but happens often enough to feel mildly irritating.

I also felt that while the stainless steel link strap looks sharp and sturdy, it tends to attract dust quickly. Fine particles settle into the joints within days of outdoor use. Sure, you could blame the Delhi AQI for this too, as it's practically the national scapegoat at this point, but it genuinely takes away from the experience, or at least it did for me. The metal straps also raise concerns around sweat buildup over time, especially in the Indian summers.

Motorola also shipped silicone and vegan leather straps, and compared to the stainless steel, they feel average. The point is not about them being uncomfortable, but they are not particularly premium either. Considering straps are the primary point of contact with the user, this area could have been more refined.

SOFTWARE EXPERIENCE

With the latest Moto Watch, the company has ditched WearOS and has bet on MotoWatchOS, and this changed my experience in many ways. Navigation through swipe gestures remains smooth, though the crown's sensitivity occasionally disrupts the flow.

The interface felt way smoother when compared to the other devices in the same price bracket. Swiping through menus, accessing widgets and reading notifications feels fluid. The good part was that there were no crashes or unexpected restarts. Furthermore, the notifications arrive promptly, and the wrist detection works consistently.

However, the limitation lies in ecosystem flexibility, as it doesn't allow you to install third-party apps. This means no Spotify, Strava or expanding beyond what's preloaded in the watch. In a market where competitors offer broader app ecosystems, this feels restrictive.

Another complaint that I have with the makers is that the call logs do not sync automatically on the watch as they do on your handset. One of the practical